

BANDED WOOLLY BEAR

**SLOW AND STEADY**

The Isabella tiger moth can breed in the High Arctic by having a long life cycle. Its woolly bear caterpillars hatch in summer and feed for a month. In winter, they freeze solid and lie dormant. They repeat the process for up to 14 years before pupating and emerging as adults that live for only a few days.

Includes one of the world's largest archipelagos

ARCTIC HARE



Birds come to the Canadian Arctic to breed, but leave before winter

WINTER WHITEOUT

Like other Arctic land mammals, the Arctic hare has exceptionally dense fur, which traps warm air close to the skin. In the south of its range in Newfoundland, hares molt into a gray-brown summer coat. Further north, where the thaw is negligible, they stay winter white all year.

FISH OF THE DAY

Arctic cod are not fished commercially, but feature in the diets of other predators. They are targeted from below by seals, belugas, and narwhals, and from above by birds such as guillemots, or murres, which dive to more than 330 ft (100 m), using their wings to "fly" underwater.

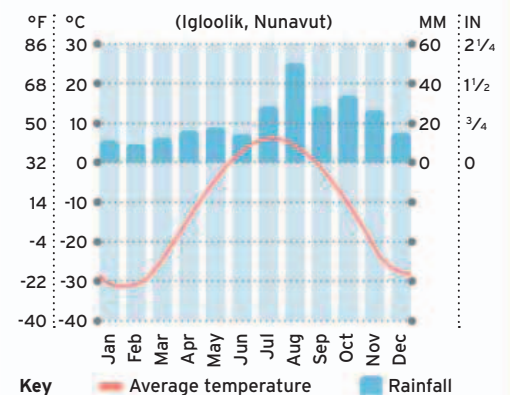
ARCTIC COD

**LOCATION**

The northernmost parts of the Canadian mainland and the islands, comprising part of the Northwest Territories and the mostly Inuit territory of Nunavut.

**CLIMATE**

Temperatures are very low all year, only rising above 32°F (0°C) for 6-10 weeks in summer. Average annual temperatures are well below freezing, and virtually all precipitation falls as snow.

**GETTING WARMER**

The Arctic is warmer now than at any time in the last 40,000 years, and the extent and duration of sea ice reduces every year. In 2007, the Northwest Passage linking the Atlantic and Pacific remained ice free for the first time in recorded history. This change in conditions can have profound effects on the growth of plankton, on which all marine life ultimately depends. The sea ice is vital to polar bears, which need it for hunting and breeding.

